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Industry Connect

AMD's David Bennett on gaming, competition & India

David Bennett, Corporate VP, APAC Region, AMD tells Digit why he loves to talk about the competition and where AMD's headed.

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Rory Read (AMD CEO) recently said that the current AMD chips could not match against Intel's and the new chips were a year away. Your comment?

I can't speak for Rory but it's no secret where we position our products. We do not position our CPUs against an i7 and when it comes to pure x86 performance, Intel is the leader. If we lived in an x86 world, Intel would be on all of the consoles and they'd be no room for an AMD APU. I admit we have a lot of work to do with our x86 products but if you look at the way our products are performing in the channels, we're doing very well. But, when it comes to my mind, we are not focused on x86 compute, we're focused on Total Compute. And the adoption of OpenGL, OpenCL and HSA is a big indicator that we've made the right move. Look at the amount of die space we've dedicated to our GPUs and compare that to our competition. Haswell, Broadwell both have increased GPUs now but we already did that ages ago.

Overall, how much of AMD's revenue comes from gaming?

Okay, that relates to something Rory said last year. He made a commitment last year that by end of next year, that 50% of AMD revenues will be generated from new business, as opposed to 64% from traditional PC centric business right now. So, what qualifies as new? Embedded, servers and semi-custom like the consoles. I've made a personal commitment that the APAC region's going to be the first to reach this 50% goal. Gaming, by itself, is a little harder to break down but as per our new diversification, we're on track with our goals. If you look at the numbers



David Bennett
Corporate VP, APAC Region, AMD

from the consoles, both Microsoft and Sony have gone on record to state that this has been the fastest selling launch for new consoles, so obviously that's driving a huge percentage of our revenues. If you look at our strategy for the next couple of years, it's gaming and VR that we are also focused on.

Why is AMD missing from the mobile SoCs segment? Both your competitors (Intel and NVIDIA) are there, so what could be the reason?

When it comes to tablets, we're absolutely there in Windows tablets and we make the best Windows tablets on the planet, bar none. I hope Windows tablets continue to grow and the better they get, the stronger we'll get. We've spent the last couple of years designing products with the customer in mind and what I mean by that is that we used to focus on core CPU and pure speed but a couple of years ago we adopted a refreshed design philosophy where we said that let's design stuff that

actually gives better real world performance. And that's what our APUs do. In the same price bracket, plus or minus \$100 - \$200, you put our product next to a competing product and we're going to perform better. We're also focused on graphics and gaming. What we're not interested in is an \$8, bottom of the barrel, really low-end processor that provides just good enough or sub-par experience. We're very interested in leveraging our assets and our IP to provide high-performance graphics and gaming in mobiles and tablets. If you look at the market, it's really focused on the low-end and that will change. So, what we've announced with ARM or in Project Skybridge, is us very clearly stating that we will have the best ARM processor and as ARM and Android step-up, there will be a place where we'd like to play.

What are the trends in India with respect to GPU sales?

I'll be completely honest. When I came on, everybody told me, don't bother with India, there's no market for GPUs. But I've seen my GPU sales increase every quarter since I've had this job, over the last three quarters. If you look at our competitiveness against NVIDIA, we've never been more competitive. Card for card we offer better value, at a better price, hands down. We've got Mantle, we're on the consoles, we've got a lot of momentum. So, as the Indian middle class expands, and it has more disposable income, coupled with the fact that a majority of the population is young, all of that is going to be huge for gaming. A lot of it will depend on broadband infrastructure, but I see both PC and console gaming expand here and that'll be good for AMD. **d**

You can read the rest of the interview online at <http://dgit.in/XSSUA7>